

Satie and his young protégés. Poulenc was also introduced to avant-garde poets such as Guillaume Apollinaire and Paul Eluard, and was inspired to try his hand at composing, despite being largely self-taught.

His first pieces, including the well-known *Trois mouvements perpétuels* for piano, showed a natural talent for attractive, melodic music with a touch of gentle parody, and established him as a composer.

In 1920, at a concert of new music by some of Satie's protégés (Poulenc, Arthur Honegger, Darius Milhaud, Georges Auric, Germaine Tailleferre, and Louis Durey), the composers were dubbed by a critic as simply *Les Six*, a name that stuck, even though they had little in common. Poulenc was perhaps the most successful of the group in the 1920s, gaining a reputation as a *bon vivant* as well as a composer of urbane and witty music such as the ballet *Les Biches*, and a host of songs setting poems by Apollinaire and Eluard.